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Submitter Information

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General Comment

Large Language Models and other Generative AI technologies as they are currently being developed and marketed are a dangerous infringement on the rights of writers, visual artists, filmmakers, actors, and musicians.

Allowing for such models to be trained on illegally obtained copyrighted work denies the very essence of copyright protections enshrined in law.

Allowing major corporations to make AI models of existing or deceased persons, sets a dangerous precedent for creative work of those persons. How will a consumer, or regulator know if an appearance in a film is a human actor, or an AI-generated replica? Is the artist who is duplicated allowed recourse?

The potential for misuse in other areas of everyday life is equally terrifying. Imagine a world where because AI replication is of a high fidelity identity cannot be established for someone at the other end of a phone or video call, and the potential for all manner of fraud or security risks. Deepfakes and non-consensual sexual material are areas where we already see rampant abuse of the powers of existing AI tools.

We should not be plunging headlong into embracing these technologies when our social structures struggle to adapt.

Already, too many people try to rely on information "generated" by large language models; those tools are not search engines, cannot understand context, and have no concept of what is real or what is not.

A machine must never be in the position of making a choice that can devastate human lives, especially since they cannot be trusted to be accurate to reality.

AI can do amazing things, and is good at filtering images or testing possible protein folding sequences, or mapping the sky or planet. But it is not yet and may never be in a position to have human-like cognition and may never be able to have the critical human quality of empathy.

I urge the NSF to weigh these factors in designing the regulations for AI tools and technology, and move to restrict the many potential unethical, dangerous, and harmful ways they are already being used in the search for profits at the expense of human beings.